

Request email, to the Superintendent — draft, not sent

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Drafted 3 September 2026. Companion to the Town Accountant request; deliberately does not overlap it. Everything here is a district document or a district question — nothing that MUNIS produces.

Cut on 3 September: a section asking for FY2023–FY2026 proposed and approved budgets. We hold all eight of those documents already — they are on disk and in the document table. What is missing is that five of the eight have never had their figures extracted, so the coverage matrix reported them as absent. That is our work, not a request. Anything else in this draft should be checked the same way before it is sent.

Two things this draft does on purpose:

1. **It leads with the End of Year Financial Report**, not with the budget documents. The EOYR reports spending by fund, which is the single thing that separates "a grant paid for this" from "the town paid for this" — the question the whole project keeps running into and cannot answer from the town's ledger.
 2. **It asks for counts, never for children.** The placement question is asked as an aggregate by setting and year, with an explicit note that nothing identifying is wanted and that small categories can be suppressed or merged.
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Subject: A few district documents, and three questions

Dear Dr Fortuna,

I run an independent archive of Lunenburg's budget documents at lunenburgbudgetproject.org — every figure traces to a document anyone can download, and where the district's own budget shows careful work I try to say so. I have a separate request in with the Town Accountant for ledger reports. This one is only for things the district holds, and I have kept it off that list so nobody is asked twice.

1. DESE End of Year Financial Report

The submissions for FY2023, FY2024, FY2025 and FY2026, in whatever form you file or retain them.

This is the one I would take first if only one were possible. It reports spending **by fund**, which is the distinction I cannot make from anything else I hold: the town's ledger shows the general fund and nothing beside it, so a budget line that rose because the district grew looks exactly like one that rose because a grant stopped paying part of it. The EOYR separates those.

It bears directly on something in the FY2026 books. Every paraprofessional account in the district ran over budget that year, while two grant funds — 2813 and 2814, which I believe are the federal special education award — spent \$229,398 and \$179,637. Those may have nothing to do with each other. I cannot tell from outside, and I would rather not write it up until I can.

2. A crosswalk between the budget and the ledger

Which MUNIS account each line of the school budget is built from. Any one year would do; it is the mapping I need, not the amounts.

This is the only thing on either of my requests that is not a report, and the only thing that would let a single budget line be followed into the town's books. At the moment the budget prints a line name and the ledger prints a ten-character account name — MS GUIDANC and HS GUIDANC are both function 2710 — so matching them is inference rather than tracking, and I would rather not publish inference.

The budget is built in a workbook, so whoever builds it may already hold this in some form. If it exists only in somebody's head, a rough version is still worth more to me than none.

Three questions

Is fund code 240 the federal special education grant? Funds 2813 and 2814 in the town's special revenue report are labelled FY25 #240 and FY26 #240. I am reading a code, not a document, and everything I might write about grant-funded staffing turns on whether I have read it right.

Does anything record whether a budgeted position was filled? A ledger records dollars and not people, so from outside an unfilled post and an underspent salary line are identical. One FY2026 account was budgeted at \$98,784 for a school psychologist and paid nobody at all; I can see that the money was not spent and nothing else. If a position control report or staffing roster exists, that would explain several of the largest variances in the year.

Out-of-district placement counts, by setting and year. For FY2023 onward: how many students were placed privately, how many through a collaborative, how many in district.

I am asking for **counts only** — no names, no identifiers, nothing about any individual student, and I do not need anything below the level of a total per setting per year. If any category is small enough that a count would identify someone, please merge it with another or leave it out and say so; a suppressed number is a perfectly good answer and I would publish it as suppressed.

The reason I ask is narrow. In FY2026 the private placement line spent \$522,629 less than budgeted and collaborative tuition spent \$434,108 more, and the two nearly cancel. That pattern has an obvious reading — that children moved from one setting to another — and it has several others that fit the same numbers just as well, including that one line was simply over-budgeted for years. **Dollars cannot tell those apart and**

counts can. Without them the honest thing to publish is that the data does not say, which is what I have published so far.

If any of this is easier some other way

I would rather be corrected than given the thing I asked for. If a document does not exist in the form I have described, or exists under a different name, or would take real work to produce, telling me so is genuinely more useful than the document — I can usually rework the question around what does exist.

Thank you for your time.

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